



INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE REDESIGN OF ETSY

VI CONRAD AND TEETAWAT TRAKULSUEBCHAI

MARCH 20, 2024



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Overview

About Etsy:

Etsy is an e-commerce company founded in 2005 that provides users with an online marketplace for handmade, unique items and gifts. It has since expanded to include multiple niches, such as vintage and digital items. It connects buyers and sellers worldwide and provides a platform for individuals and small businesses to sell their goods. The image to the right is the mobile homepage of the Etsy website.

The Etsy mobile site extends this marketplace's reach, allowing users to browse, shop, and manage their accounts on the go. This project will enhance the Etsy mobile user interface, making it more user-friendly for new users. We will achieve this by simplifying the design and improving the navigation. These improvements make first-time mobile site experiences more welcoming and less overwhelming, encouraging new users to explore and engage with the Etsy community.

This project aims to enhance the mobile website's information architecture, focusing on simplifying design and improving navigation for an enhanced user experience.

Major Content Areas

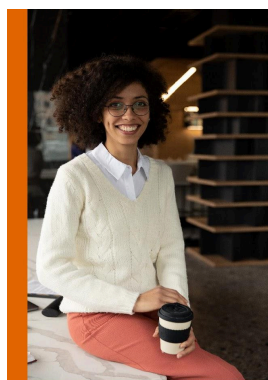
- **Product Listings:** Price, Images, Category, and Product Detail.
- **Seller and Shop Information:** Seller Profile, Shop Profile, Ratings, details, products for sale
- **Categories:** Product categories + Subcategories for niche items
- **Shopping Cart and Checkout:** Cart management, Checkout process
- **Search functionality:** Effective filtering options
- **User Profile:** Shopper profile, Favorites and recently viewed items, Direct Messaging, Rate items/Products

The Project

Objectives

- Simplify the design and navigation of Etsy's mobile website.
- Enhance user experience for both buyers and sellers.
- Improve the findability of products and features.
- Streamline the purchasing process for users.

Persona(s)



Age	28
Gender	Female
Occupation	Marketing Coordinator
Education	Bachelor's degree

Lily Anderson

Personality: Creative, Thoughtful, Enjoys

About

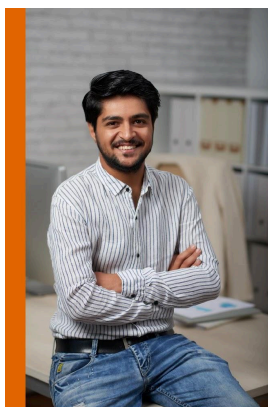
Lily is the go-to person for gift recommendation and home decoration. She believes that gift should be as unique as the person receiving it and enjoys. Recently introduced to Etsy, Lily is excited about the prospect of supporting independent creators.

Goals

- To discover unique gifts that reflect the personal tastes and interests of her friends and family.
- To support small business and independent creators.
- To find inspiration for her own projects.

Challenges

- Navigating a new platform to find exactly what she wants.
- Ensuring the quality and authenticity of the items she purchases.



Age	35
Gender	Male
Occupation	Architect
Education	Master's Degree

Satja Nair

Personality: thoughtful, imaginative, and detail-oriented

About

Satja appreciates the story behind each piece he considers for his home. He values craftsmanship and the personal touch that comes with handmade items. His home is more than just a living space; it's a reflection of his journey, tastes, and the ambiance he wants to cultivate for himself and his visitors.

Goals

- Satja's primary goal is to create a living space that is both unique and reflective of his personal aesthetic.
- He aims to support small businesses and independent creators.
- Satja is committed to decorating his home in a way that aligns with his environmental and ethical values.

Challenges

- Satja faces the challenge of selecting pieces that blend harmoniously within his chosen theme.
- As a new user of Etsy, it's difficult to determine the authenticity and quality of items.
- Satja needs to balance his desire for distinctive pieces with a budget.

Usage Scenarios

Lily Anderson explores Etsy to find unique gifts that reflect her style. She navigates the platform and discovers a seller with exquisite, handmade ceramic vases perfect for her best friend. Communicating with the seller to customize the vase, she feels a sense of accomplishment in supporting a small business. Pleased with the quality and service, she leaves a review, reinforcing her role as a supporter of independent artisans.

Satja Nair searches Etsy in an attempt to find distinctive, eco-friendly décor for his new house. He starts by carefully choosing objects that fit his artistic vision and ethical principles. After carefully weighing his options, he purchases a piece of art made of recycled materials that relates to his dedication. His home now reflects his ideals and is a haven of carefully chosen crafts. This wonderful experience he had on Etsy not only makes his room seem beautiful, but it also strengthens his resolve to support independent artisans and sustainable methods.

Key Task Flows

KEY TASK: Complete a purchase.

1. Browse the website.
2. Select the item to buy.
3. Add item to cart.
4. Review the cart.
5. Proceed to checkout.
6. Apply coupons (if available)
7. Enter shipping information.
8. Enter payment details.
9. Review the order.
10. Confirm order.
11. Submit Order.
12. Receive confirmation of purchase.

KEY TASK: Communication with the seller

1. Browse the website.
2. Select the Product
3. Message the seller.
4. Inquire about product information.
5. Request customization (if applicable)

Content Creation Process

1. **Content Inventory:** Identifying primary and secondary navigation items on the existing site.
2. **Free Listing:** Brainstorming and listing cards and categories.
3. **Initial Card Sort:** Sorting navigation elements to improve clarity.
4. **Revised Card Sort:** Refining categories based on initial feedback.
5. **Treejack Test Round 1:** Evaluating the navigation.
6. **Treejack Test Round 2:** Revise categories based on initial results.
7. **First Click Testing:** Testing user understanding and navigation.

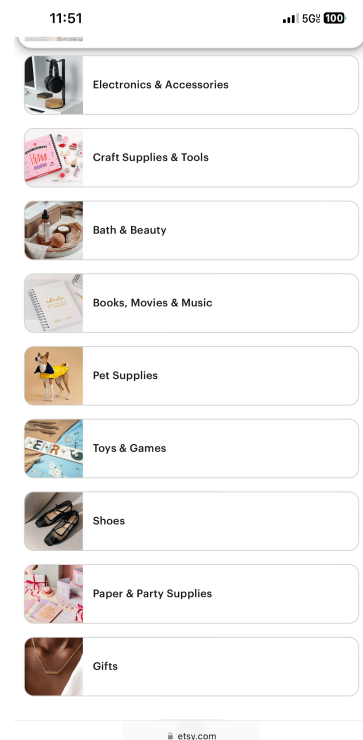
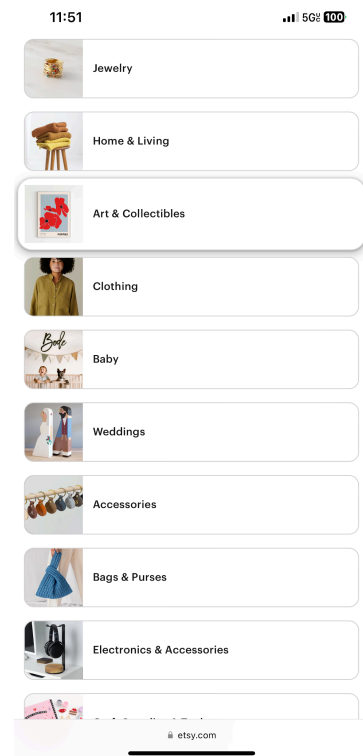
Content Inventory

We cataloged all existing categories and secondary categories found on the Etsy website. These include a diverse range of options spanning from Home Deals to Jewelry & Accessories, Clothing & Shoes to Toys & Entertainment, and more. Our aim is to streamline navigation, ensuring users can easily comprehend the structure and functionality of our interface. By condensing these categories into concise groupings, we strive to enhance user experience and facilitate smoother interaction with our platform.

Categories:

- Home Deals
- Jewelry & Accessories
 - Accessories
 - Bags & Purses
 - Necklaces
 - Rings
 - Earrings
 - Bracelets
 - Body Jewelry
- Clothing & Shoes
 - Women's
 - Men's
 - Kid's & Baby
 - Bags & Purses
- Home & Living
 - Home
 - Bath & Beauty
 - Pet Supplies
- Wedding & Party
 - Party Supplies
 - Invitations & Paper
 - Wedding Decorations
 - Wedding Gifts
 - Wedding Accessories
 - Wedding Clothing
 - Wedding Jewelry
- Toys & Entertainment
 - Toys & Games
 - Electronics & Accessories
 - Books
 - Movies & Music

- Art & Collectibles
 - Prints
 - Photography
 - Painting
 - Sculpture
 - Glass Art
 - Drawing & Illustration
 - Mixed Media & Collage
 - Fiber Arts
 - Dolls & Miniatures
 - Collectibles
- Craft Supplies & Tools
 - Home & Hobby
 - Jewelry & Beauty
 - Sewing & Fiber
 - Papercraft
 - Visual Arts
 - Sculpting & Forming
- Gifts & Gift Cards
- Etsy Registry



Free Listing

After completing the content inventory, we compiled a list of all elements relevant to Etsy. Afterward, we organized these items into distinct categories for better organization and clarity. We conducted a thorough reassessment of the categories and subsequently restructured them in preparation for the card-sorting process.

Initial Categories:

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
1	Jewelry & Accessories	Clothing & Shoes	Home & Living	Wedding & Party	Toys	Entertainment	Art	Collectibles	Craft Supplies & Tools	Gifts	Pets	Account	Purchases	
2	Necklaces	Shirt	Couch	Veil	Toy Truck	Musical Instruments	Fine Art	Vintage Plates	Crochet Hook	Custom Guitar P	Dog Collar	Wishlists	Cart & Checkout	
3	Earrings	Blouse	Chair	Wedding Décor	Wooden Horse	TV Console	Prints	Vintage Ring	Knitting Needles		Cat Collar	Messages	Seller Ratings & Reviews	
4	Rings	Tie	Table	Wedding Accessories	Playing Cards	Personalized Wine Glass	Photography	Antique ring	Bookbinding Kit		Pet Bandana	Gift Card		
5	Bracelets	Skirt	Sofa	Wedding Clothing	Slingshot	DIY Tequila Kit	Paintings	Foreign Coins	Calligraphy Pen		Dog Shoes			
6	Vintage Earrings	Slacks	Wooden Spoon	Gold Cake Topper	Stuffed Animal		Drawings		Ink					
7	Tie Pin	Jeans	Spatula	Happy Birthday Sign	Bowling Set				Frame					
8	Top Hat	Vintage Dress	Plates	Edible Drink Toppers	Dinosaur				Pottery Yam Bowl					
9	Beanie Hats	Embroidered Sweatshirt	Ladder	Custom Neon Sign					Camera Film					
10	Baseball Caps	Boots	Bed Sheet	Custom Party Games					Stamps					
11	Purses	Sneaker	Fitted Sheet						Turtle Charms					
12	Backpacks	Heels	Comforter						Raw Fabric					
13	Custom Sunglasses	Oxfords	Blanket						Patterns					
14		Doc Martens	Vintage Home Décor											
15														
16														

Revised for Card Sort:

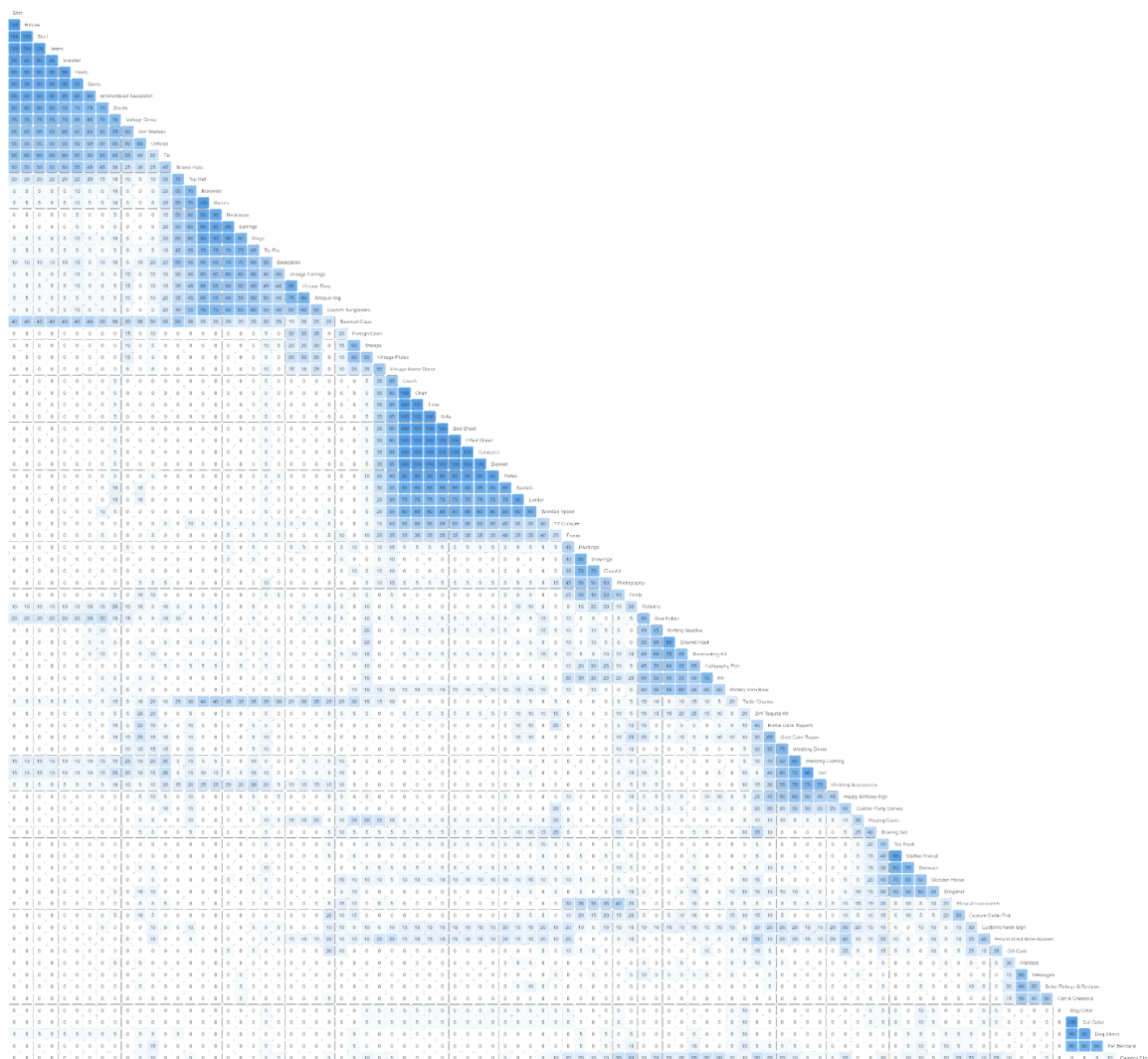
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
19	Jewelry & Accessories	Clothing & Shoes	Home & Living	Wedding & Party	Toys	Entertainment	Art	Collectibles	Craft Supplies & Tools	Gifts	Pets	Account	Purchases	
20	Purses	Shirt	Table	Wedding Décor	Toy Truck	TV Console	Fine Art	Foreign Coins	Knitting Needles	Gift Card	Dog Collar	Messages	Cart & Checkout	
21	Necklaces	Jeans	Sofa	Wedding Clothing	Stuffed Animal	Custom Party Games	Drawings	Stamps	Crochet Hook	Personalized Wi	Cat Collar	Wishlists	Seller Ratings & Reviews	
22	Earrings	Blouse	Fitted Sheet	Wedding Accessories	Dinosaur	Playing Cards	Paintings	Vintage Plates	Bookbinding Kit	Custom Guitar P	Dog Shoes	Seller Ratings & Reviews		
23	Bracelets	Sneaker	Couch	Veil	Wooden Horse	Bowling Set	Photography		Raw Fabric		Pet Bandana	Cart & Checkout		
24	Rings	Heels	Comforter	Gold Cake Topper	Slingshot		Prints		Calligraphy Pen					
25	Tie Pin	Embroidered Sweatshirt	Chair	Happy Birthday Sign	Bowling Set	Musical Instruments	Frame		Pottery Yam Bowl					
26	Custom Sunglasses	Boots	Blanket	Edible Drink Toppers		Edible Drink Toppers			Ink					
27	Backpacks	Slacks	Bed Sheet						Patterns					
28	Vintage Earrings	Vintage Dress	Plates											
29	Top Hat	Tie	Spatula											
30	Vintage Ring	Doc Martens	Wooden Spoon											
31	Antique ring	Oxfords	Ladder											
32	Beanie Hats	Beanie Hats	Vintage Home Décor											
33			TV Console											

Card sort

Card Sort Round 1

In our initial round of card sorting, we enlisted 20 participants sourced from acquaintances, family, and classmates. This hybrid card sorting session revealed a challenge stemming from overly specific cards and categories, leading to confusion and overlapping. Notably, most users didn't opt to create their own categories. Some user-generated categories included Sport Accessories, Clothing > Materials, Footwear, Mail, Musical Instruments, Personal Belongings, and Travel. [The similarity matrix for card sort one is below, but it is easier to read here.](#)

Out of the initial 26 participants, 20 completed the study, taking a median time of 10 minutes and 42 seconds. The range varied from a minimum of 5 minutes and 6 seconds to a maximum of 35 minutes and 15 seconds. Participants were predominantly from the United States (95%), with a minority from Canada (5%). Across the board, participants collectively formulated 272 categories, averaging 14 categories per participant.



The second round with 12 participants showed improvement after using more general card names, although some niche cards like "Sculpting" and "Paintings" still posed categorization challenges. A key takeaway was the need to refine terminology for customized items, steering clear of overly specific terms such as "custom guitar pick." This round also utilized a hybrid sorting approach, with only one user-created category: "Bags." [The similarity matrix for card sort two is below, but it is easier to read here.](#)

Ties
100 Shifts
100 100 Plants
100 100 100 Shoes
100 100 100 Children's Apparel
91 91 83 83 91 91 Bottom
50 50 50 50 50 50 Ties
33 33 33 33 33 33 50 Hats
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 75 Sunglasses
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 33 66 91 Jewelry
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 41 66 91 83 Purses
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 33 66 75 83 66 Bags
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 25 58 75 96 66 66 Backpacks
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 25 33 33 25 33 50 Luggage & Travel
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 41 Storage & Organization
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 33 91 Furniture
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 33 91 100 Kitchen Utensils
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 33 91 100 100 Blankets
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 33 91 100 100 100 Home Decor
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 33 83 91 91 91 Bedding
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 41 75 83 83 83 75 Dining
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 16 16 16 16 16 16 Piercings
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 85 Drawings
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 66 75 Visual Arts
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 41 58 66 Sculpting & Forming
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 Sewing
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 25 25 25 16 16 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 16 33 50 66 Jewelry Making
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 41 41 66 50 41 41 Photography
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 16 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 96 58 50 25 8 8 33 Prints
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 8 16 Custom Guitar Pick
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 0 0 0 8 0 16 83 Custom Neon Sign
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 25 25 25 25 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 66 Custom Sunglasses
0 8 8 58 50 58 Custom Party Game
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 66 58 50 41 Gift Cards
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 25 25 25 25 25 25 16 0 0 8 0 0 8 16 33 16 8 33 25 Toys
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 25 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 16 8 8 16 8 8 8 25 8 25 8 0 25 8 66 Board Games
0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 8 16 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 16 8 0 0 25 16 16 8 0 0 33 41 Musical Instruments
0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 8 18 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 0 8 8 8 16 Settings
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 8 83 Profits
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 0 8 8 8 8 83 Messages
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 0 8 8 8 8 83 Help
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 8 8 0 66 83 83 83 Favorites
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 8 8 8 0 8 8 8 8 66 83 83 83 Cart
0 Dogs
0 Cats
0 Other Pets
8 8 8 8 8 8 8 8 16 8 8 8 0 16 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 16 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 Wedding Clothing
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 8 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 91 Wedding Decorations
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 8 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 91 91 Wedding Accessories
16 15 16 16 16 16 8 8 8 0 16 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 91 83 83 Wedding Shoes
0 0 0 0 0 0 0 8 0 0 0 0 0 0 16 0 0 0 8 8 16 8 8 8 0 16 0 0 8 8 8 0 0 0 0 0 Paper & Party Supplies

Card Sort Analysis

The disparities between the first and second rounds of card sorting sessions were notable, showcasing a discernible evolution in user behavior and navigation preferences. In the initial round involving 20 participants, the hybrid card sorting method revealed challenges stemming from overly specific cards and categories, leading to confusion and overlap. However, in the subsequent round with 12 participants, adjustments were made to employ more general card names, resulting in an improved user experience. While both rounds utilized a hybrid sorting approach, a key difference emerged in the number of participants and their approach to creating categories. Round one saw a larger participant pool, with 20 out of 26 completing the study, while round two boasted a completion rate of 12 out of 15. Additionally, participants in round one generated a higher total of 272 categories, with a median of 14 categories each, compared to 126 categories and a median of 10 categories per participant in round two. These differences underscore the iterative nature of the card-sorting process and the importance of refining terminology and structure to enhance user comprehension and navigation effectiveness.

Treejack Testing

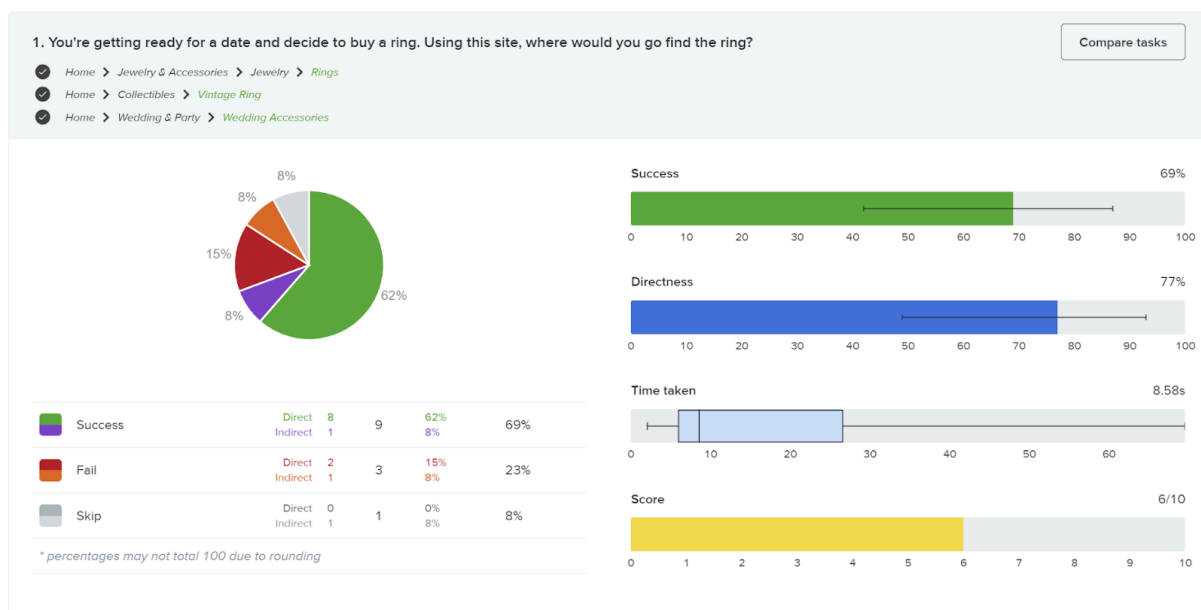
Treejack Round 1

The Treejack testing began with 13 participants in the first round, with 4 abandoning the study. The overall success rate was 67%, with a directness of 65%, and an average completion time of 1 minute and 59 seconds. Task completion rates varied, with scores ranging from 4/10 to 6/10. This allowed us to identify areas for improvement in the navigation.

Participants were predominantly from the United States (8), with contributions from Thailand (4) and Saudi Arabia (1). Regarding device usage, 9 participants utilized mobile devices, 3 used desktops, and 1 opted for a tablet.

These task-specific metrics shed light on the effectiveness of our site's navigation. While some tasks demonstrated relatively high success rates, others revealed challenges in directness and completion. Such findings will guide us in refining the site's structure to enhance user experience and streamline task fulfillment.

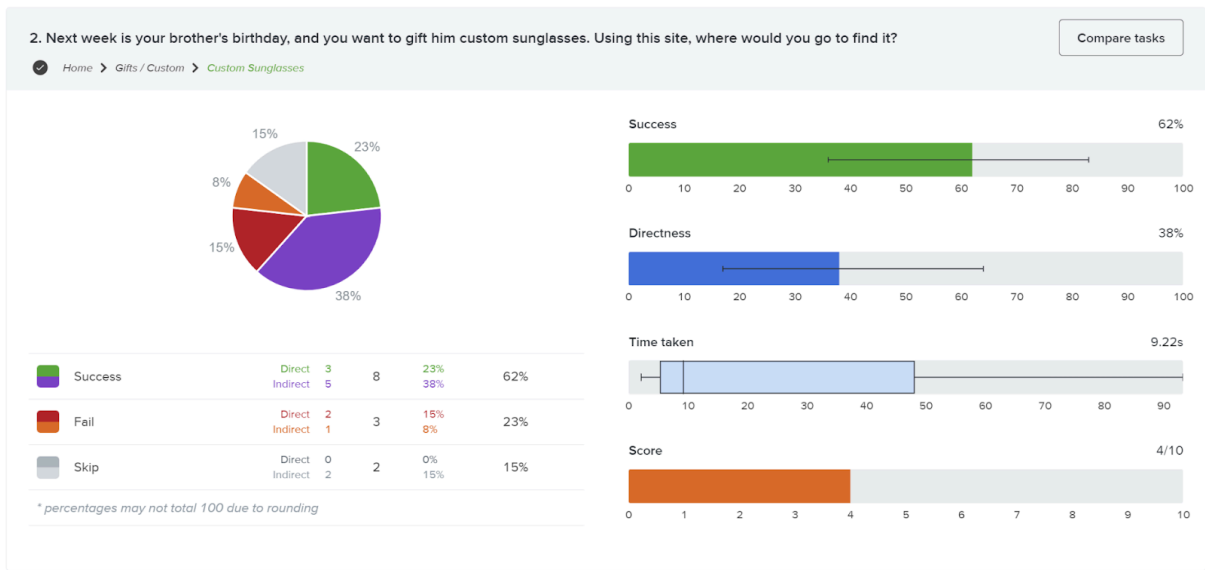
Task 1: You're getting ready for a date and decide to buy a ring. Using this site, where would you go find the ring?



Task 1 Result:

The test results are fairly good, showing that most people can find what they're looking for quickly and directly. However, the fact that not everyone succeeded and the overall score was a 6 out of 10 suggests there's still room to make the website even easier to use.

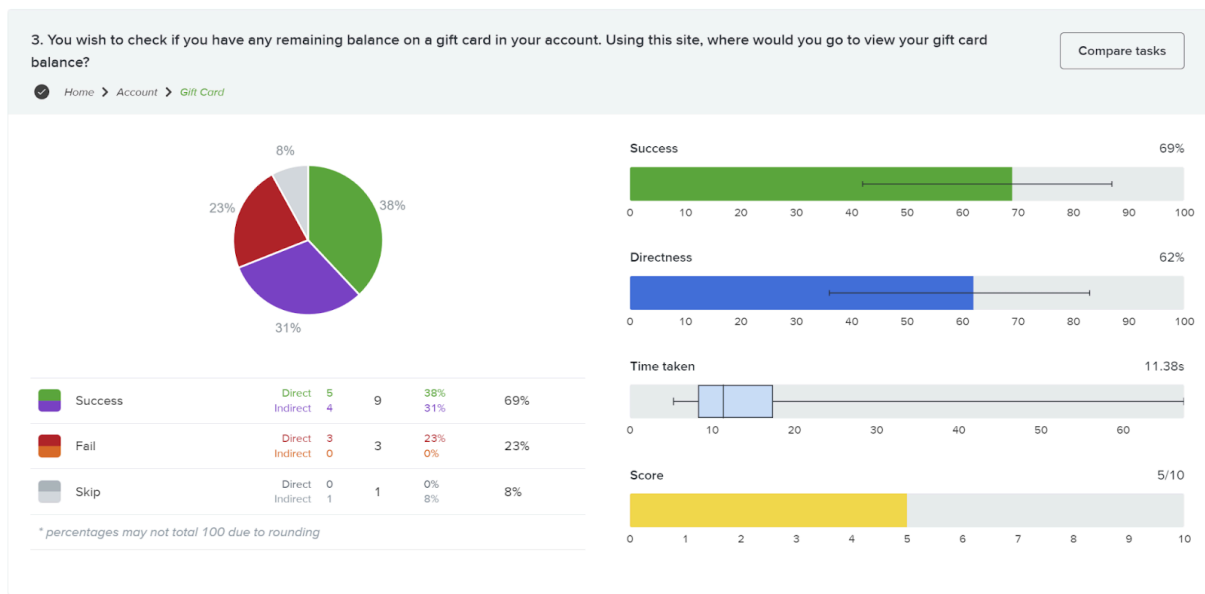
Task 2: Next week is your brother's birthday, and you want to gift him custom sunglasses. Using this site, where would you go to find it?



Task 2 Result:

The user testing shows a success rate of 62%, indicating that most users could complete the task of finding custom sunglasses. However, the directness score is lower at 38%, suggesting that the navigation path could be more intuitive.

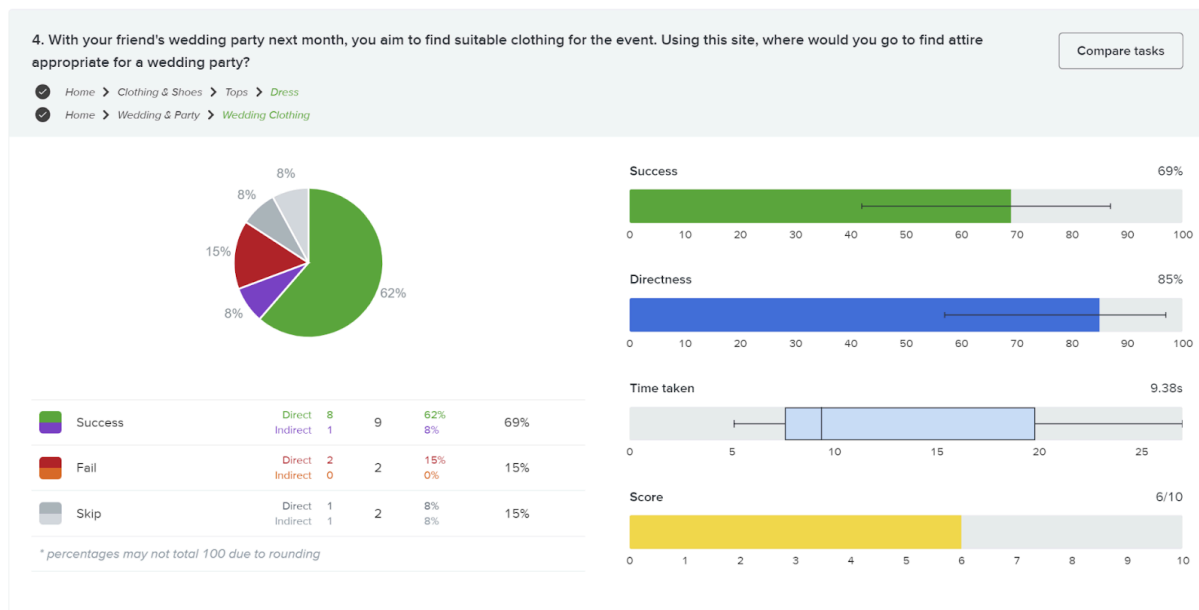
Task 3: You wish to check if you have any remaining balance on a gift card in your account. Using this site, where would you go to view your gift card balance?



Task 3 Result:

Most people could complete the task and find a straightforward path to the destination, but a middling score of 5 out of 10 indicates the process could be made more user-friendly.

Task 4: With your friend's wedding party next month, you aim to find suitable clothing for the event. Using this site, where would you go to find attire appropriate for a wedding party?



Task 4 Result:

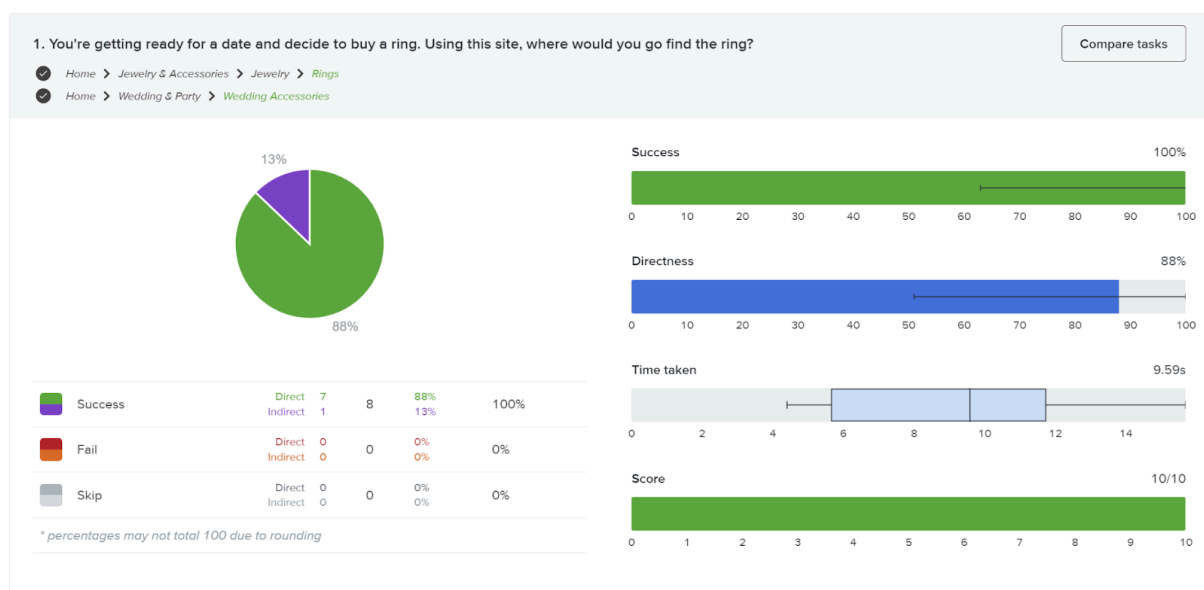
This appears to be a very promising outcome. The majority of users found wedding clothing with a 69% success rate, and an 85% directness score shows that most of them did so without taking any wrong turns. Impressive is also the fast average time of 9.38 seconds.

Treejack Round 2

In the second Treejack round, 8 participants completed the test, with no dropouts. This round saw a significant improvement, with an overall success rate of 94%, a directness of 78%, and an average completion time of 1 minute and 42 seconds. Task completion rates also improved, with scores ranging from 7/10 to 10/10, indicating substantial progress in user understanding and navigation efficiency.

Participants were solely from the United States, with 7 utilizing desktop devices and 1 using a mobile device. These findings underscore our progress in refining the site's navigation, enhancing user experience, and facilitating smoother task completion.

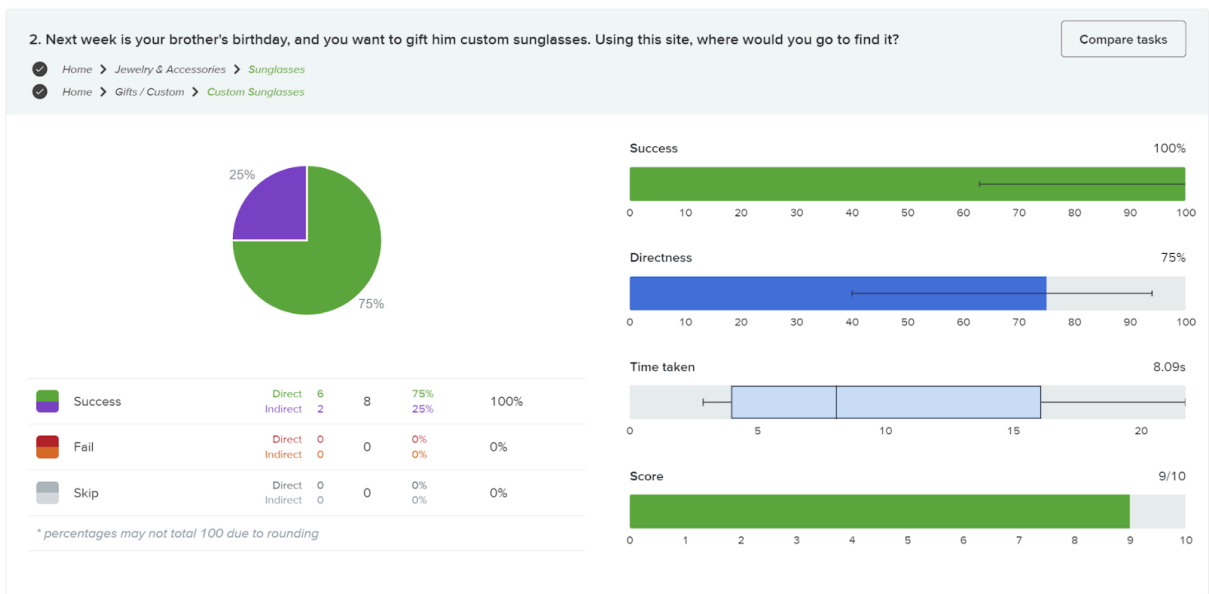
Task 1: You're getting ready for a date and decide to buy a ring. Using this site, where would you go find the ring?



Task 1 Result:

This is a very good outcome. Users find the ring easily, with an 88% directness and 100% success rate. The user experience for this work is excellent, as evidenced by the perfect score of 10/10 and the time taken of less than 10 seconds. However, the smaller sample size might affect the result.

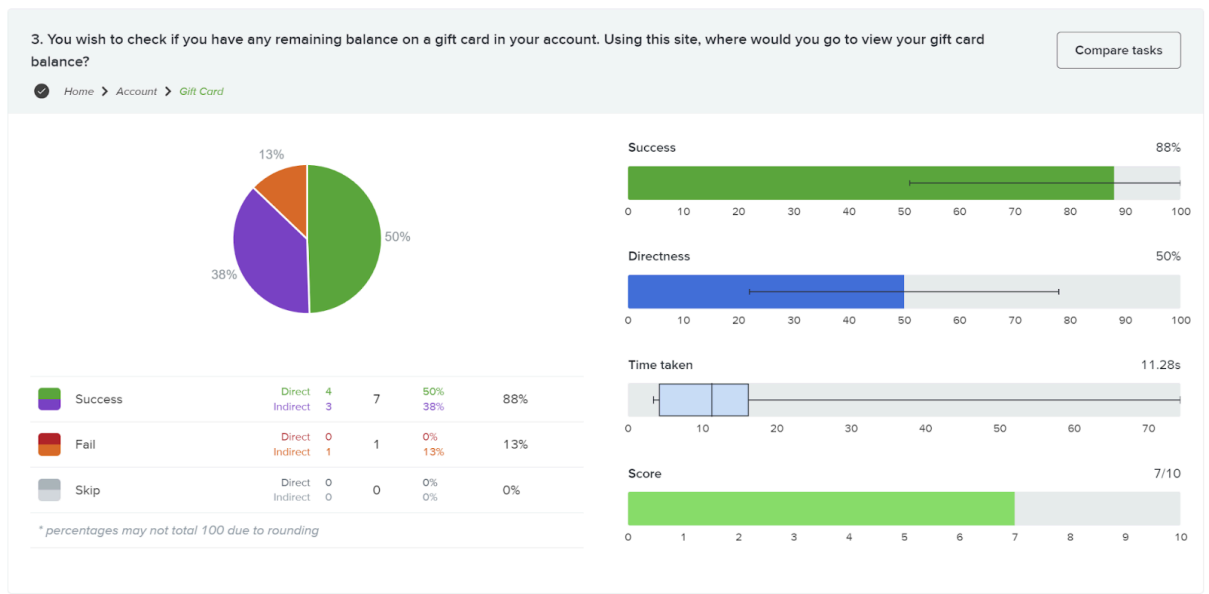
Task 2: Next week is your brother's birthday, and you want to gift him custom sunglasses. Using this site, where would you go to find it?



Task 2 Result:

This test shows excellent results, with everyone finding the custom sunglasses quickly and most taking a direct route, reflected in the high satisfaction score.

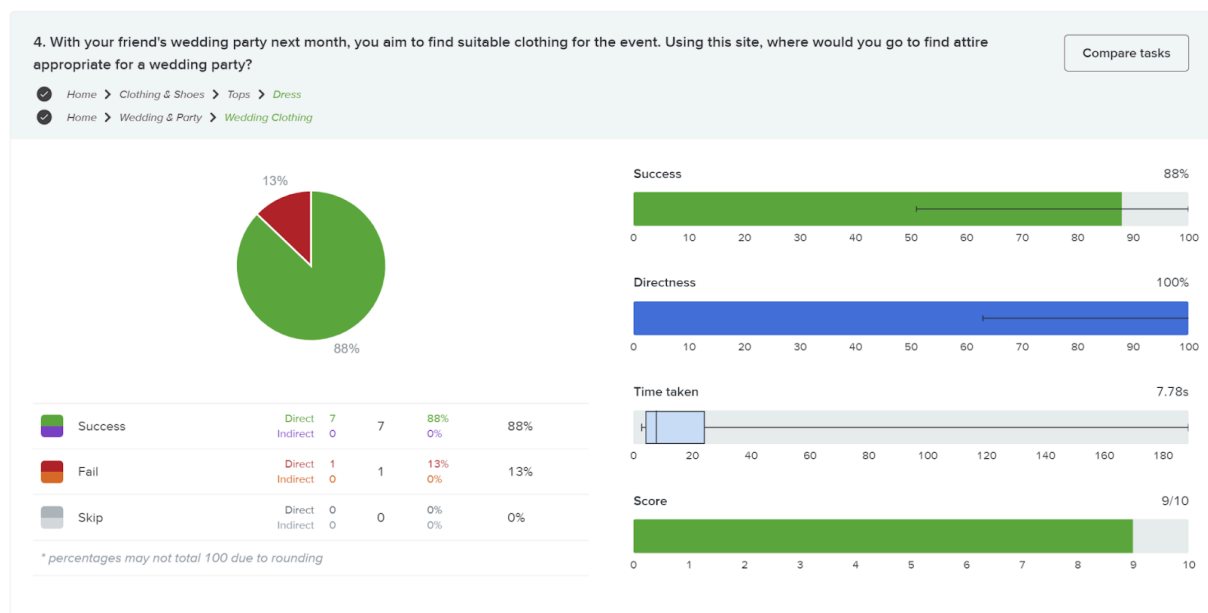
Task 3: You wish to check if you have any remaining balance on a gift card in your account. Using this site, where would you go to view your gift card balance?



Task 3 Result:

Most users successfully checked the balance on their gift cards, while some went around direct routes. The overall score was 7 out of 10, which indicates an excellent but not perfect user experience, and the work was finished in an acceptable amount of time.

Task 4: With your friend's wedding party next month, you aim to find suitable clothing for the event. Using this site, where would you go to find attire appropriate for a wedding party?



Task 4 Result:

The excellent result, with an 88% success rate, shows that most people found the correct destination. The task took an average of less than 8 seconds, and users gave the task experience a high rating of 9 out of 10.

Treejack Analysis

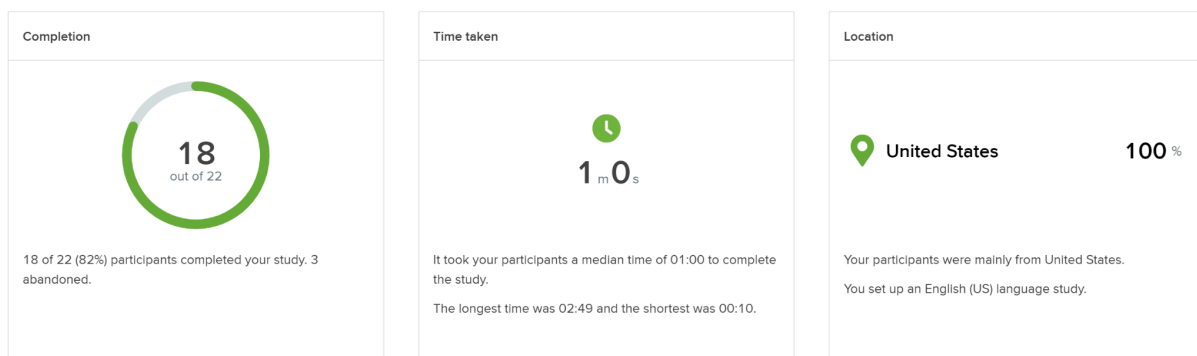
The disparities between rounds one and two of the Tree test are notable, reflecting significant improvements in user performance and task completion rates. Round two boasted a remarkable 94% overall success rate, a considerable leap from the 67% observed in the initial round. Likewise, the directness score rose from 65% to 78%, indicating enhanced user understanding of navigation pathways. While round one featured 13 participants with varying device usage, round two saw a smaller cohort of 8 participants, predominantly utilizing desktop devices. This variance in participant numbers and device usage likely played a role in the differing outcomes between the two rounds. Nonetheless, the substantial progress observed

in round two underscores the effectiveness of adjustments to the site's navigation structure, facilitating smoother user interactions and improved task comprehension.

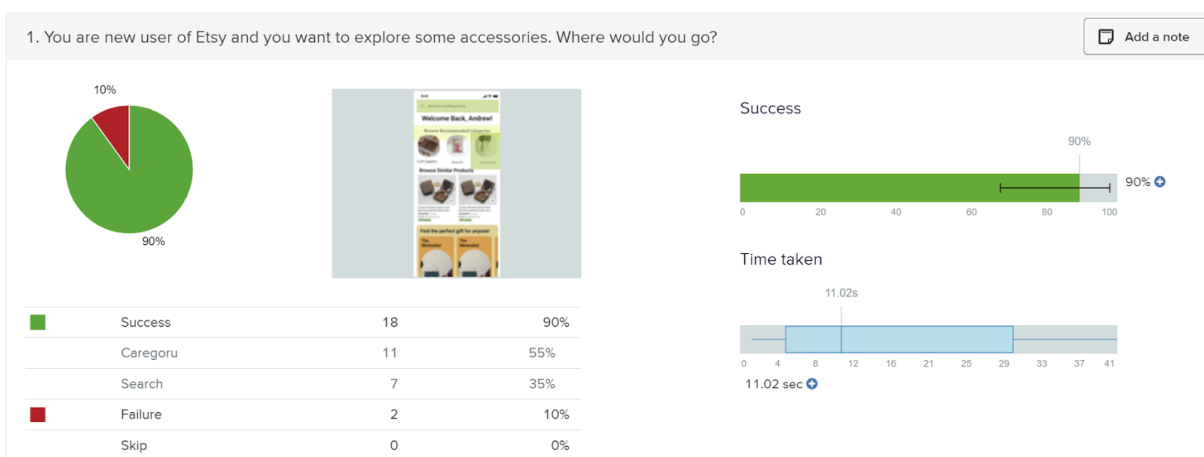
In analyzing the results of the Treejack test, it's important to acknowledge potential factors that may have influenced user behavior and responses. While the overall success rates and task completion times provide valuable insights into the effectiveness of the navigation structure, it's essential to consider the possibility of outliers and varied interpretations of tasks. For instance, in Task 1, where participants were prompted to find a ring for a date, responses such as "kitchen utensils" and "blouse" suggest potential instances of misunderstanding or lack of serious engagement. While such divergent responses may indicate areas for clarification or improvement in the interface, it's worth noting that not all participants may have encountered difficulties or approached the tasks with the same level of seriousness. This variability underscores the importance of conducting thorough user testing, gathering qualitative feedback, and interpreting results within the context of individual user experiences and perceptions. Acknowledging and addressing these nuances can refine the navigation structure to better meet our users' diverse needs and expectations.

First Click Testing

We only completed one first-click test. The First Click test involved 20 participants, and we gleaned notable insights regarding initial click paths and user behavior. The median completion time for the test was 01:04, with durations ranging from 00:10 to 02:49. This assessment shed light on areas of confusion and inefficiency in users' initial interactions with the interface, offering valuable guidance for refining user journeys and interface design. Out of the 24 participants engaged, 83% successfully completed the study, while 4 participants abandoned it. The median time for completion stood at 01:04, with the longest completion time recorded at 02:49 and the shortest at 00:10. Task-specific outcomes revealed promising success rates, with a 90% success rate achieved for both tasks. Participants took an average of 11.02 seconds to locate accessories and 9.92 seconds to find seller contact information for personalized cutting boards. These findings underscore the importance of intuitive navigation and accessible contact options, contributing to enhanced user satisfaction and efficiency within the platform.



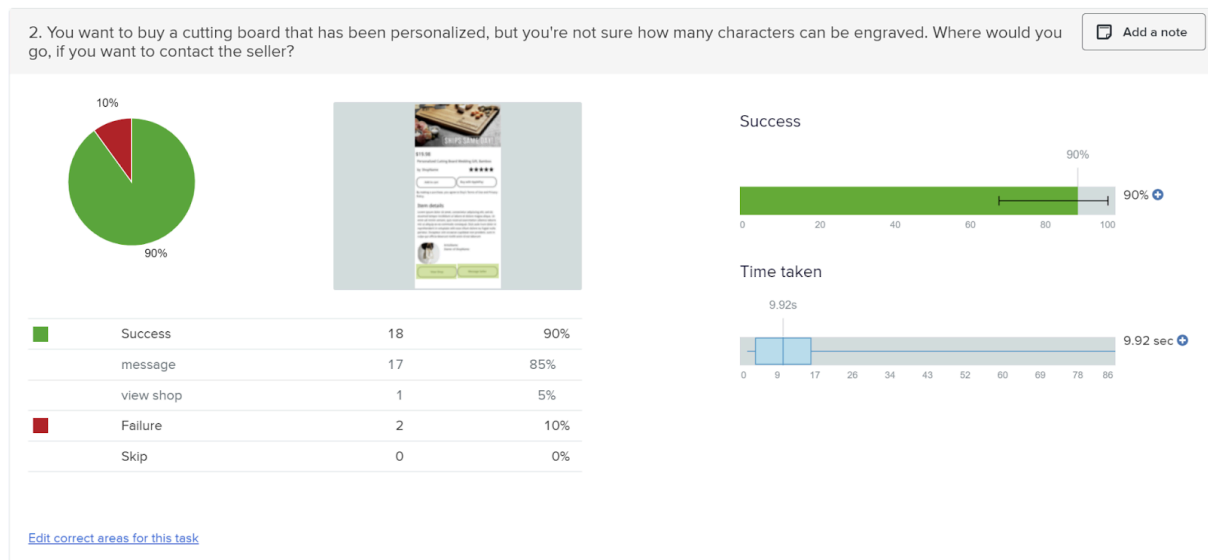
Task 1: You are new user of Etsy and you want to explore some accessories. Where would you go?



Result:

In the first-click testing, 90% of users correctly clicked on the correct area to identify accessories, which shows a good result. The activity was finished quickly, indicating an easy-to-use user interface.

Task 2: You want to buy a cutting board that has been personalized, but you're not sure how many characters can be engraved. Where would you go, if you want to contact the seller?

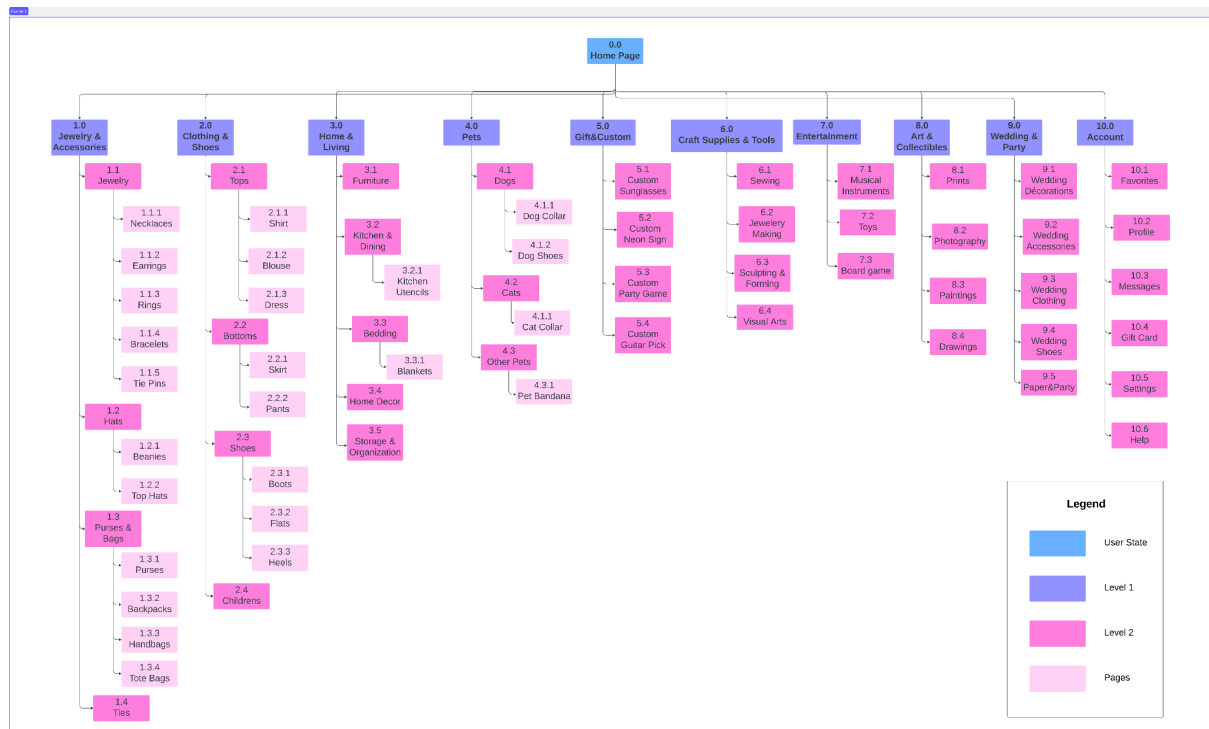


Result:

90% of users successfully complete their tasks and contact the supplier to order a personalized cutting board, demonstrating good task performance.

Site map

This sitemap has been finalized. We went through various rounds of card sorting after multiple iterations. Since the feedback on the current version was the most positive, we decided to go with a simpler sitemap.

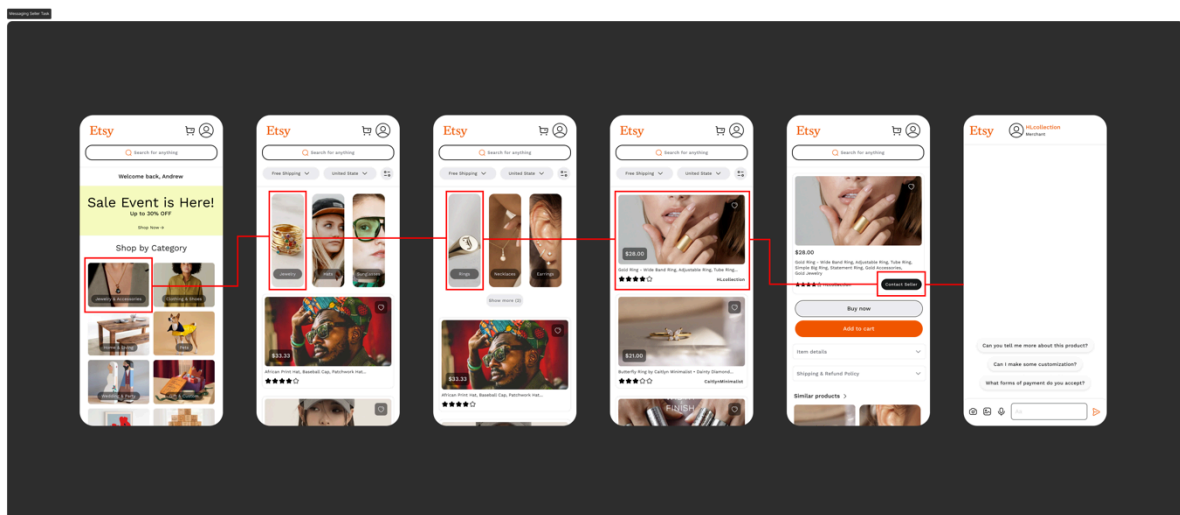


Wireframe

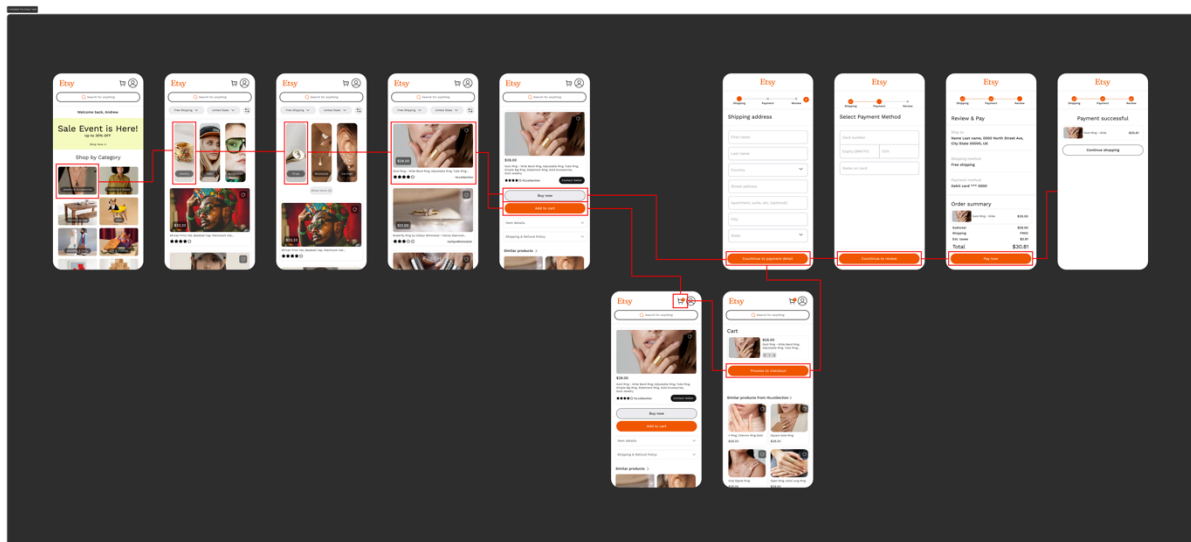
The choice to focus on these specific tasks stemmed from their close alignment with our project's core objectives. We aim to establish a platform that caters to beginners, providing them with a seamless and intuitive experience that encourages interaction and exploration. By prioritizing tasks that mirror our project's goals, we can better assess the effectiveness of our wireframe design in achieving these objectives.

[Link to live prototype](#)

Task 1: Contact Seller



Task 2: Complete Purchase

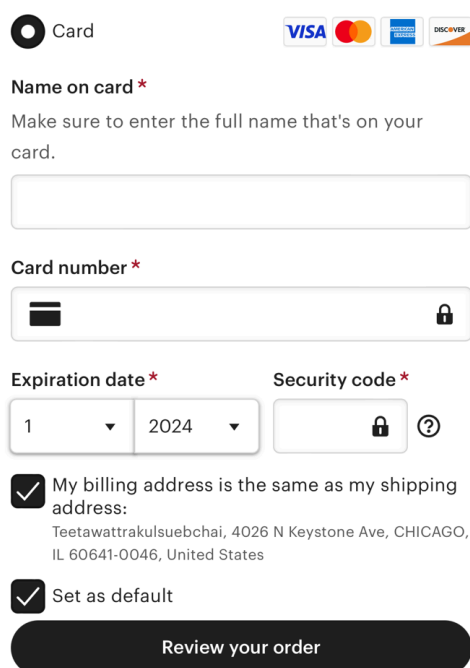


Reflection

We encountered several notable challenges in our UX research endeavors that informed our iterative design process. Initially, our user interface suffered from an overload of non-essential information, which proved to be a significant hurdle for new users navigating the site. Additionally, the disproportionately large size of checkboxes contributed to a cluttered appearance and raised potential usability concerns. Further challenges emerged during card and tree sorting exercises, where we grappled with an abundance of categories and overly specific cards, complicating the sorting process. Moreover, the wording of tasks in tree tests could have been clearer to ensure participants grasped the objectives accurately. Combining tasks such as adding items to the cart and checking out may have inadvertently caused confusion, warranting a need for clearer task separation. Recognizing the multifaceted nature of our app's diverse niches, we learned that simplicity is paramount for effective user engagement.

To address these challenges and optimize user experience, we formulated several recommendations. Firstly, we proposed simplifying card names by adopting more general terminology and avoiding niche-specific terms to streamline categorization and improve user understanding. Additionally, we advocated for finding alternative ways to describe customized items without resorting to overly specific language that might confuse users. Furthermore, we suggested refining the navigation structure of the mobile website based on insights gleaned from tree testing and first-click studies, ensuring essential tasks such as product discovery and purchasing are readily accessible. We proposed refining the layout, labeling, and positioning of navigation elements and features to enhance task clarity and minimize user confusion. Finally, we emphasized the importance of continued testing and

iteration, advocating for regular usability tests to gather feedback and drive iterative improvements in the information architecture and navigation of the mobile website. We aim to iteratively enhance the



Card

Name on card *
Make sure to enter the full name that's on your card.

Card number *

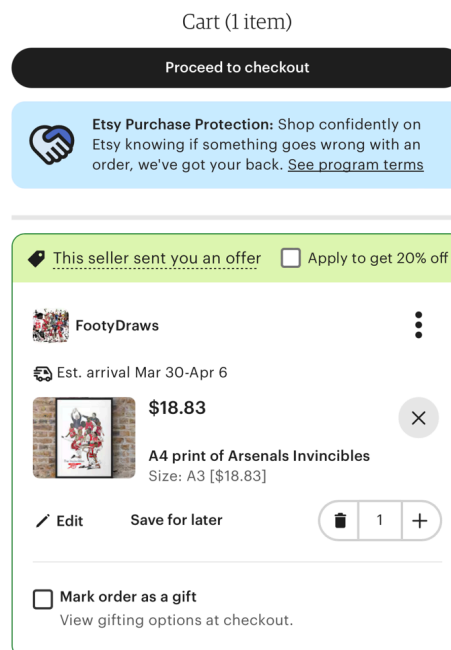
Expiration date * 1 2024

Security code *

☒ My billing address is the same as my shipping address:
Teetawattrakulsuebchai, 4026 N Keystone Ave, CHICAGO, IL 60641-0046, United States

☒ Set as default

Review your order



Cart (1 item)

Proceed to checkout

Etsy Purchase Protection: Shop confidently on Etsy knowing if something goes wrong with an order, we've got your back. [See program terms](#)

This seller sent you an offer ☐ Apply to get 20% off

FootyDraws

Est. arrival Mar 30-Apr 6

\$18.83

A4 print of Arsenal's Invincibles
Size: A3 [\$18.83]

Edit Save for later

☐ Mark order as a gift
View gifting options at checkout.

user
experience
through
these

recommendations, fostering greater user engagement and satisfaction with our platform.

Challenges

Initial User Interface Overload: The wireframe initially suffered from abundant non-essential information, resulting in a cluttered and overwhelming experience for new users. This inundation of content could potentially hinder users' ability to navigate the site effectively and find the information they need promptly. Addressing this challenge involves streamlining the interface by focusing on essential elements and minimizing unnecessary distractions.

Disproportionate Checkbox Size: Another challenge observed in the wireframe design was the disproportionately large size of the checkboxes. This oversized visual element contributed to a cluttered appearance and could lead to usability issues, especially on smaller screens or mobile devices. Resolving this challenge requires adjusting the size and layout of checkboxes to ensure a more balanced and visually pleasing interface that enhances usability for all users, regardless of their device or screen size.

Successes:

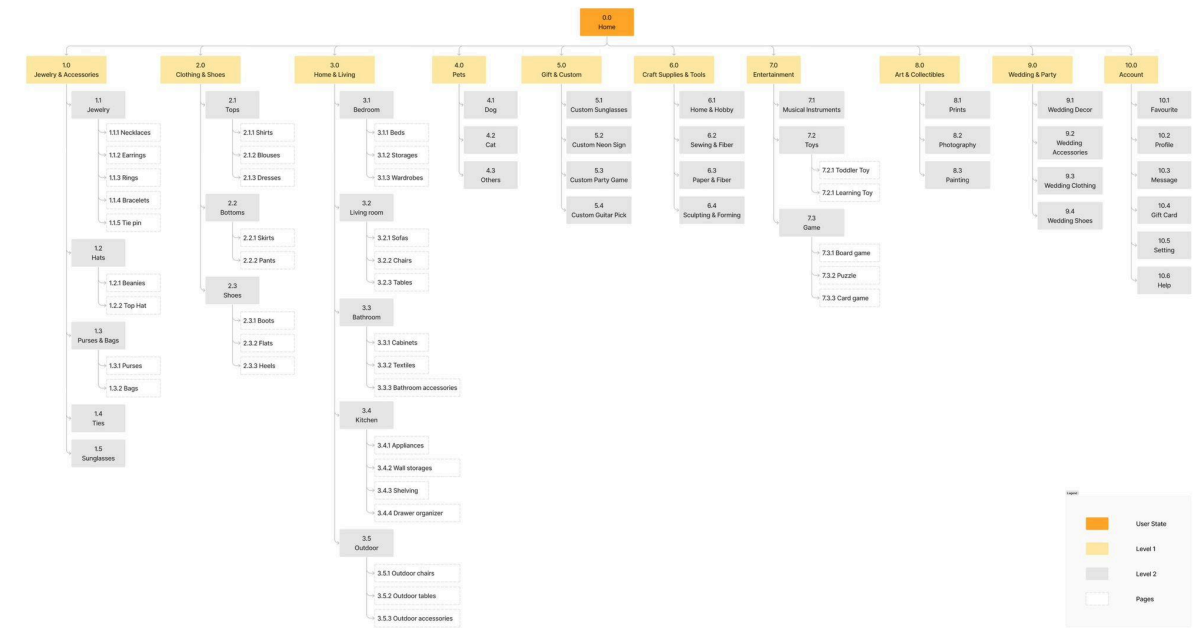
By embracing a minimalist design philosophy, we effectively purged extraneous content, yielding a streamlined and user-centric interface that markedly alleviated confusion for newcomers. Our efforts focused on refining the checkout process, a pivotal aspect of user interaction. Notably, we downsized checkboxes, thereby augmenting both the interface's aesthetic appeal and functional efficiency. This meticulous attention to detail ensures a seamless user experience, enhancing usability and overall satisfaction with our platform.

Appendix

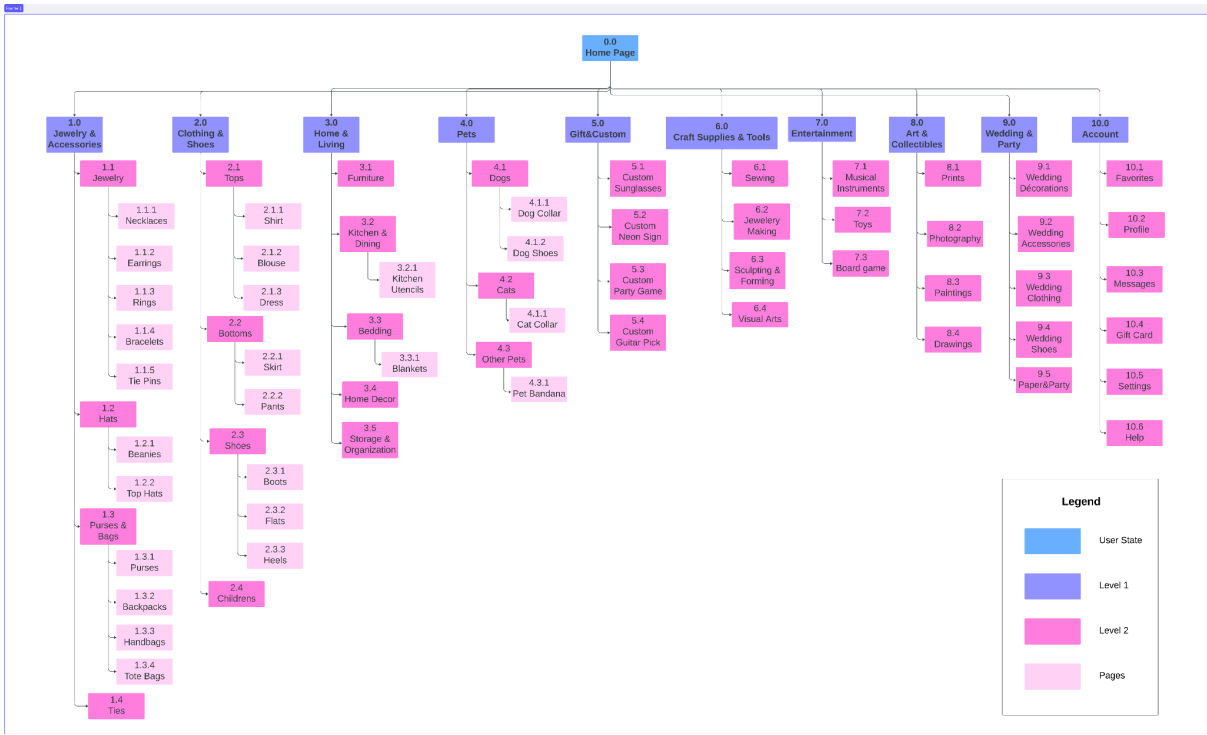
Site Map Draft

Home				Home & Living	
	Jewelry & Accessories				Furniture
		Jewelry			Kitchen Utencils
			Necklaces		Bedding
			Earrings		Blankets
			Rings	Pets	
			Bracelets		Dog Collar
			Tie Pin		Cat Collar
		Hats			Pet Bandana
			Beanie		Dog Shoes
			Top Hat	Gifts / Custom	
		Purses & Bags			Custom Sunglasses
			Purses		Custom Neon Sign
			Backpacks		Custom Party Games
		Tie			Custom Guitar Pick
				Craft Supplies & Tools	
					Home&Hobby
					Sewing&Fiber
					Paprt&Party
					Sculpting&Forming
	Clothing & Shoes			Entertainment	
		Tops	Shirt		Musical Instruments
			Blouse		Toys
			Dress		Board game
		Bottoms		Art & Collectibles	
			Skirt		Prints
			Pants		Photography
		Shoes			Paintings
			Boots		
			Flats		
			Heels		

Site Map Version 1



Site Map Version 2



Site Map Annotations

0.0 Home Page

- The site's entry point mirrors the app's desktop version, and users can select a category from a menu to begin browsing. They have access to all the categories but must log in to see more in-depth account pages such as favorites, profiles, and messages.

1.0, 2.0, 3.0, 4.0, 5.0, 6.0, 7.0, 8.0, and 9.0 Site and Category Navigation

- These allow the user to browse the site by category.

1.0 Jewelry and Accessories

- Category for jewelry and accessories products.

2.0 Clothing and Shoes

- Category for clothing and shoes products.

3.0 Home and Living

- Category for home and living products.

4.0 Pets

- Category for pet-related products.

5.0 Gifts and Custom

- Category for gift items and custom-made products.

6.0 Craft Supplies and Tools

- Category for craft supplies and tools.

7.0 Entertainment

- Category for entertainment-related products.

8.0 Art & Collectibles

- Category for art and collectible items.

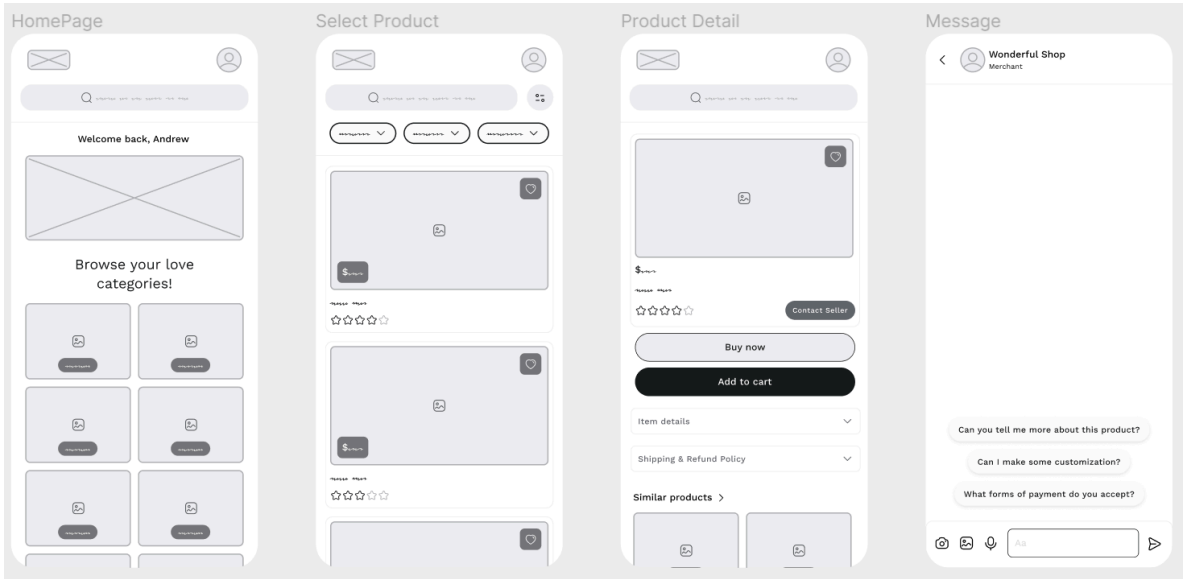
9.0 Wedding and Party

- Category for wedding and party-related products.

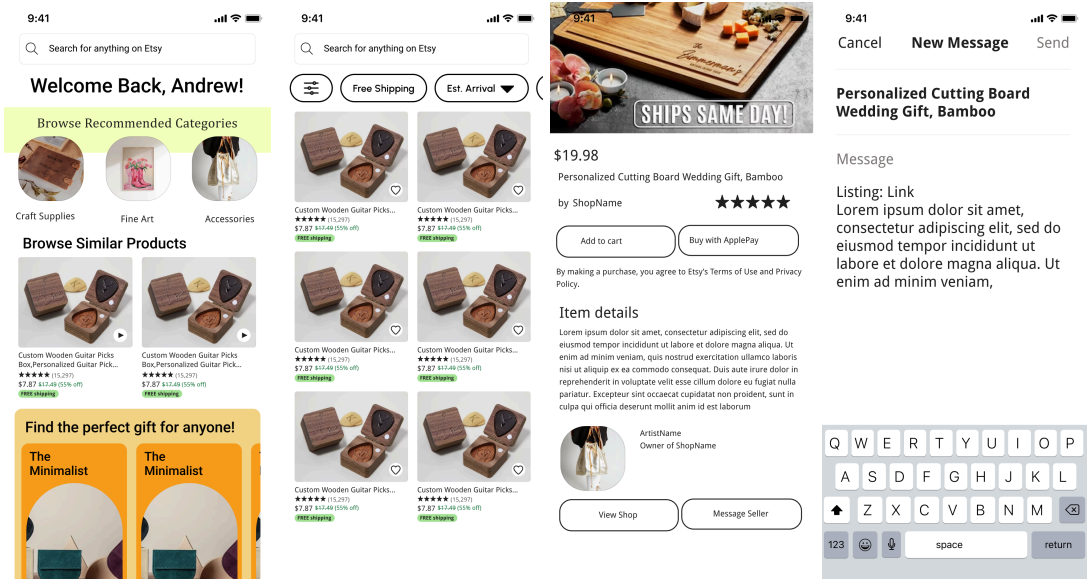
10.0 Account

- Users must log in or create an account to access favorites (10.1), profile (10.2), messages (10.3), gift cards (10.4), and settings (10.5). They do not need to be logged in to access Help (10.6).

First Draft Wireframe



Wireframe Version 1



Task1: Contact Seller

Welcome back, Andrew

Sale Event is Here!
Up to 30% OFF

Shop Now →

Shop by Category

1 Action: Locate and select the "Jewelry & Accessories" category.
Clicking directs users to the "Jewelry & Accessories" category page.

A Search Bar:
Allows users to input and search for specific items or categories.

B Banners:
Highlights deals, promotions, or featured products to encourage user.

C Categories Section:
Facilitates easy navigation to different product categories within the website.

Free Shipping ▾ United State ▾ 0-0

\$33.33

★★★★☆

2 Action: Find and select the "Jewelry" sub-category.
Clicking directs users to the "Jewelry" sub-category page.

A Filter:
Allows users to refine and narrow down the product listings according to specific preferences or requirements.

B Sub-categories Section:
Facilitates easy navigation to different sub-categories within the website.

C Products:
Provides a concise summary of each product.

Free Shipping ▾ United State ▾ 0-0

Show more (2)

\$33.33

★★★★☆

3 Action: Find and select the "Rings" sub-category.
Clicking directs users to the "Rings" sub-category page.

Free Shipping ▾ United State ▾ 0-0

\$28.00

★★★★☆

HLcollection

\$21.00

★★★★☆

CaitlynMinimalist

4 Action: Select the first listed ring options.
Clicking directs users to the full information product page

A Favorite button:
Icon represented by a heart. Allows users to mark products as favorites or add them to a wishlist for future reference.

B Rating:
A row of 5 stars indicating the average customer rating.

C Shopper/Seller:
Text displaying the name of the seller or shop offering the product.

Free Shipping ▾ United State ▾ 0-0

5 Action: Making a purchase
Select either "Buy now" or "Add to cart"

- "Buy now" leads directly to the checkout process for a quick purchase
- "Add to cart" allows the user to continue shopping before proceeding to checkout.

A Item details:
Provides information about the product to help customers make informed purchasing decisions.

B Rating:
Provides customers information on how products will be shipped, and how to proceed if they need to return a product for a refund or exchange.

\$28.00

★★★★☆ HLcollection

Contact Seller

Buy now

Add to cart

Item details ▾

Shipping & Refund Policy ▾

Similar products >

Shipping address

First name

Last name

Country ▾

State ▾

Street address

Apartment, suite, etc. (optional)

City

State ▾

Postcode

Country ▾

Proceed to payment method

5.1 Action: Review the cart items
Enables users to review and modify their selections before proceeding to purchase, ensuring they are satisfied with their choices.

A Plus Icon/Button:
Allows the user to increase the quantity of the specific product in the cart.

B Min Icon:
Enables the user to decrease the quantity of the specific product, if the product quantity reaches zero, it may prompt removal from the cart.

C Navigation Arrows:
Allows users to browse through the selection if there are more products than can be displayed in the initial view.

Cart

\$28.00

Gold Ring - Wide Band Ring, Adjustable Ring, Tube Ring...

1

Process to checkout

Similar products from HLcollection >

\$28.00

\$28.00

\$36.00

\$29.00

Etsy

Shipping

Payment

Review

Shipping address

First name

Last name

Country

Street address

Apartment, suite, etc. (optional)

City

State

Continue to payment detail

6 Action: Fill out the shipping information form. Entering details such as the recipient's name and address.

A Progress bar: The section of the bar representing the current stage is visually distinguished to indicate progress.

Etsy

Shipping

Payment

Review

Select Payment Method

Card number

Expiry (MM/YY)

CVV

Name on card

Continue to review

7 Action: Filling out the payment information. provide the necessary payment details (e.g., card number, expiration date, CVV).

Etsy

Shipping

Payment

Review

Review & Pay

Ship to

Name Last name, 0000 North Street Ave,
City State 00000, US

Shipping method

Free shipping

Payment method

Debit card *** 0000

Order summary



Gold Ring - Wide

\$28.00

Subtotal

\$28.00

Shipping

FREE

Est. taxes

\$2.81

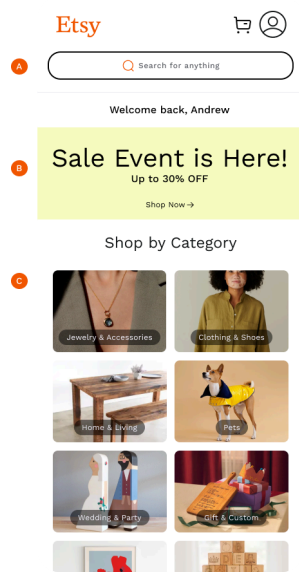
Total

\$30.81

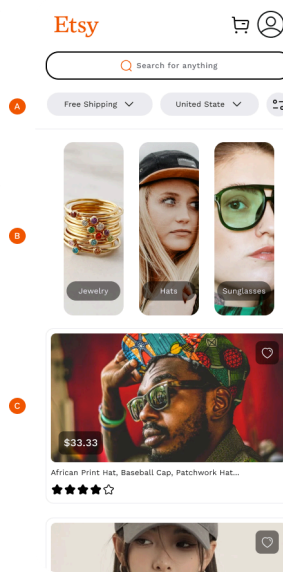
Pay now

8 Action: Review Purchase and Finalize Payment. Once satisfied, the user clicks the "Pay Now" button to finalize the transaction.

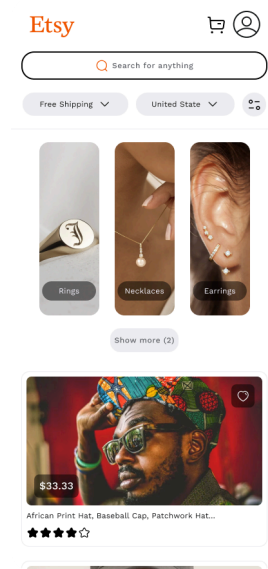
Task 2: Complete Purchase



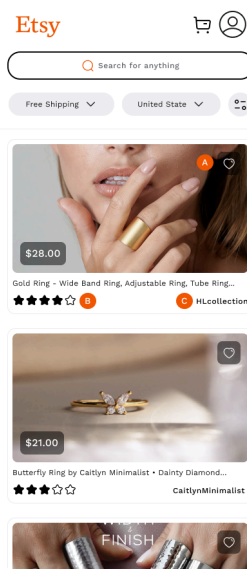
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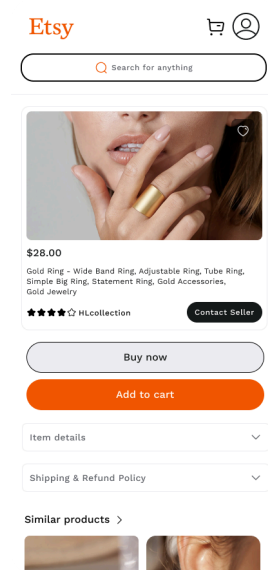
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Icon represented by a heart. Allows users to mark products as favorites or add them to a wishlist for future reference.
- B Rating:**
A row of 5 stars indicating the average customer rating.
- C Shopper/Seller:**
Text displaying the name of the seller or shop offering the product.



- 5 Action: Find and select "contact seller" button**
- A Contact seller button:**
A button that, when clicked, navigates the users to messaging interface.



- 6 Action: Inquire about a product to obtain specific information about the product**
- A Suggested messages:**
a variety of messages covering common asking questions
- B Messaging Bar with Multimedia icons:**
 - Camera icon: Allows users to quickly take a new photo or video to send immediately.
 - Image icon: Enables users to browse and select images or videos from their device's gallery to upload and send.
 - Microphone icon: Offers the ability to record and send voice messages directly within the chat.
 - Text input field: Users can type their text messages.